

Making more fish

Most fish don't make very good parents – they lay their eggs in the water and abandon them, leaving their young to fend for themselves. Some, however, do stick around.



Millions of eggs

Most fish lay eggs. Perch, like many other fish, lay an enormous number in the hope that some will hatch out. A lot of other fish like to eat the eggs, so most will be lost.

Courting

Some male fish make more of an effort to attract a female than others. The male stickleback builds a nest, then his tummy turns red to attract a female.



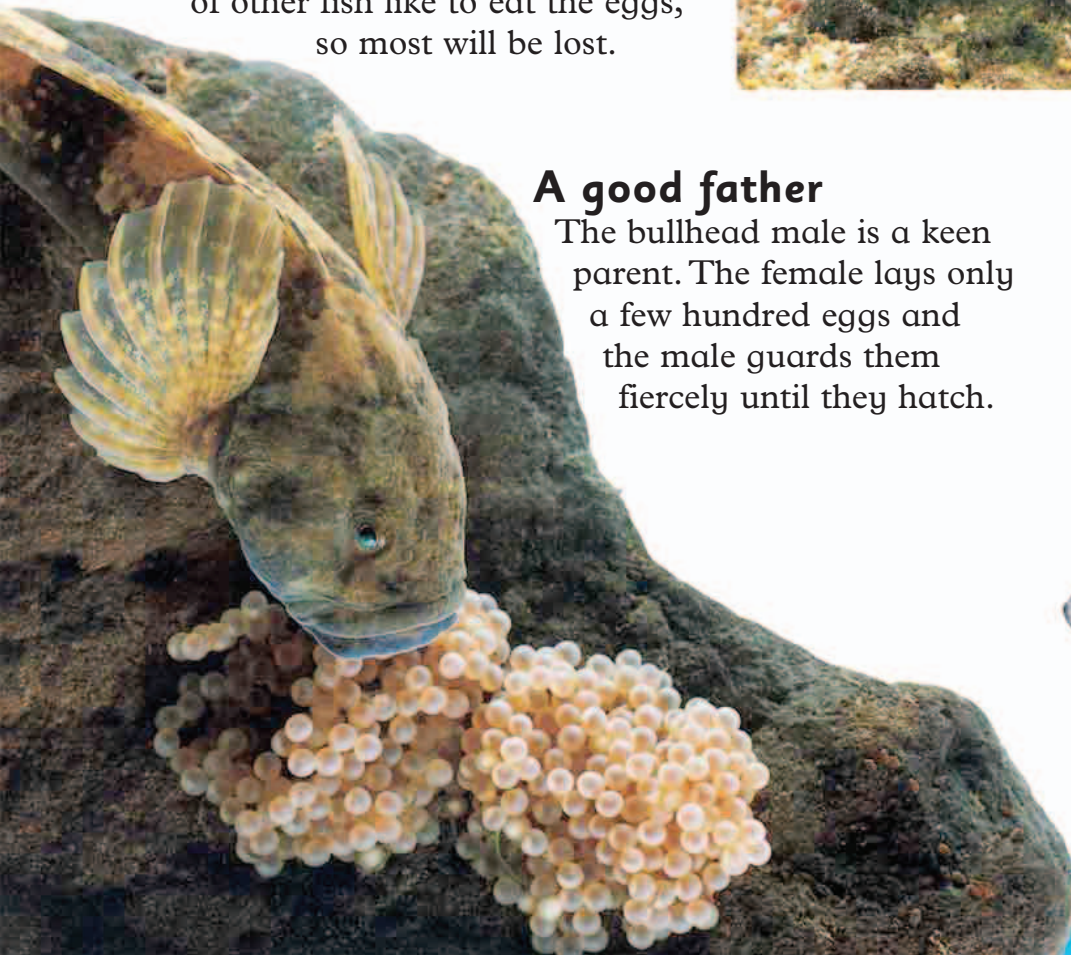
Baby sticklebacks

The male stickleback guards his eggs until they hatch.



A good father

The bullhead male is a keen parent. The female lays only a few hundred eggs and the male guards them fiercely until they hatch.



Hatching out

Most fish hatch into tiny larvae – fish that are not fully formed. They gradually grow a skeleton, fins, and organs. At this small stage they can't protect themselves easily.



Which fish lays the most eggs?